UNITED STATES
NUCLEAR REGULATORY COMMISSION
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20555-0001

March 2, 2026

MEMORANDUM TO: Jason C. Paige, Chief
Long Term Operations and Modernization Branch
Office of Nuclear Reactor Regulation
U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission

FROM: Jaison Monachan
Long Term Operations and Modernization Branch
Office of Nuclear Reactor Regulation
U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission

Signed by Monachan, Jaison on 03/02/2026

SUBJECT: SUMMARY OF JANUARY 14, 2026, PUBLIC MEETING ON U.S. NUCLEAR REGULATORY COMMISSION'S PROJECT PLAN FOR EVALUATING NEI RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ACCELERATING NRC REFORM OF THE DIGITAL INSTRUMENTAION AND CONTROL REGULATORY INFRASTRUCTURE UNDER THE EXECUTIVE ORDER 14300

On January 14, 2026, staff from the Office of Nuclear Reactor Regulation (NRR) held a Information Meeting with a Question and Answer Session to discuss the NRC's Project Plan for evaluating Nuclear Energy Institute (NEI) recommendations to reform the digital instrumentation and control (DI&C) regulatory framework (Agencywide Document Access and Management System (ADAMS) Accession No. ML25213A112). Executive Order (EO) 14300, issued May 23, 2025, directed the U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC) to reform and modernize regulations and associated guidance documents. By letter dated July 31, 2025, NEI provided specific recommendations to implement EO 14300 by enabling faster deployment of modern technology while preserving safety. The purpose of this meeting was for the NRC staff to present its plan for evaluating and identifying actions to implement the DI&C recommendations and for NEI to summarize the recommendations and the associated basis for each recommendation.

The meeting focused on:

- NRC's project plan objectives, scope, priorities, and schedule for addressing NEI recommendations.
- NEI's technical basis for their recommendations on reforming the NRC's DI&C regulatory infrastructure.

The meeting notice and the meeting presentations are available in ADAMS (ML26004A001, ML26015A088, and ML26015A096). A list of attendees is provided in the enclosure.

The meeting began with introductions and opening remarks from NRC staff, emphasizing the need to reform the DI&C regulatory infrastructure to replace aging analog systems and enable safe deployment of digital technologies that enhance safety, reliability, diagnostics, and operational efficiency. This initiative aligns with the broader scope of the Accelerating Deployment of Versatile Advanced Nuclear for Clean Energy Act (ADVANCE) of 2024 and EO 14300, which call for comprehensive updates to NRC regulations and guidance to enable the safe and secure use and deployment of civilian nuclear technologies.

NRC staff presented its project plan (ML25363A089) outlining objectives to evaluate NEI recommendations, identify underlying issues, assess challenges, propose solutions, prioritize actions, and communicate results clearly to stakeholders. The evaluation scope encompasses several key areas: revising common cause failure (CCF) policy and guidance; revising Regulatory Issue Summary (RIS) 2002-22 Supplement 1 to remove restrictions on Reactor Protection System (RPS) and Engineered Safety Features Actuation System (ESFAS) updating NUREG-0800 Chapter 7 and related guidance; endorsing industry licensing guidance in NEI 20-07; streamlining DI&C Interim Staff Guidance (ISG)-06; consolidating human factors engineering guidance; updates to Codes and Standards; and adopting systems engineering approaches.

The staff explained that the evaluation will follow a top-down review of the NRC's I&C regulatory infrastructure, starting with regulations and policy, followed by guidance and other documents. The process will use new information, data, and operating experience to support the evaluation. Staff also presented the schedule and next steps, which included completing the initial staff evaluation by the end of January, engaging stakeholders on the initial evaluation in early February, and documenting the evaluation and initiating specific actions by the end of February 2026.

NEI explained that its recommendations were developed through a task force and working group under executive leadership. EO 14300 was a key driver for reevaluating existing policies and guidance, prompting NEI to focus on credible, risk-informed approaches and comprehensive regulatory revisions. Industry modernization plans, NRC resource constraints, and EO timelines influenced NEI's approach, which aims to implement digital modernization efficiently while maintaining safety as the highest priority. NEI's goals include focusing NRC reviews on credible risk, improving efficiency and predictability, and ensuring sustainable guidance aligned with modern standards.

NEI stated their position that incremental changes under the DI&C Integrated Action Plan have not delivered expected benefits for large digital upgrades. NEI argued that CCF remains a regulatory burden without strong data support the CCF policy and recommended foundational changes to address this issue. Its recommendations fall into two categories: (1) risk-informed approaches and (2) infrastructure improvements, including consolidating guidance and eliminating duplication.

Supporting its position, NEI cited Electric Power Research Institute research and nuclear operating experience showing no platform-level software CCF across approximately two billion hours of SIL-certified Programmable Logic Controller operation. These findings discovered during development of Regulatory Guide 1.250 and NEI 17-06, indicate that software CCF events are no more problematic than other contributors and that diverse platforms would not have prevented identified events. Instead, signal and functional diversity proved effective. NEI also proposed expanding upon 10 CFR 50.59 as a viable pathway for all digital upgrades when

demonstrating low CCF likelihood. Based on this evidence, NEI urged updates to policy and elimination of 10 CFR 50.55a(h). Instead, NEI proposed reliance on the General Design Criteria (GDC) with regulatory guides to endorse modern standards and cited the current framework with GDCs and 10 CFR 50.55a(h) presents duplication of requirements.

NEI further recommended that licensing should focus on activities that reduce redundancy, diversity, separation, or independence beyond what is credited in the Final Safety Analysis Report (FSAR), rather than requiring comprehensive system reviews. These changes aim to simplify regulatory requirements, improve predictability, and accelerate modernization while maintaining adequate protection.

NEI concluded by emphasizing the urgency of accelerating digital modernization in line with Executive Order priorities. Digital upgrades were described as essential for improving plant safety, reliability, and workforce readiness, while addressing equipment obsolescence and enhancing monitoring capabilities. However, regulatory burdens were identified as obstacles.

Industry representatives expressed appreciation for the collaborative discussion and reaffirmed their commitment to enabling safe deployment of modern DI&C technologies. NEI requested clear timelines to provide input on planned activities. NRC staff confirmed that this meeting was an initial step and announced a follow-up public meeting in February to address specific challenges and recommendations consistent with the project plan schedule. Stakeholders were encouraged to review the project plan and submit comments for consideration during evaluation and implementation phases.

During the closing portion, members of the public asked questions and provided comments to the NRC staff. One member highlighted the importance of understanding differences between deterministic, risk-informed, and risk-based approaches, referencing NRC's White Paper in Staff Requirements Memorandum (SRM)-SECY-98-144. The NRC staff highlighted the Commission's 1995 Probabilistic Risk Assessment Policy to address the comment.

No regulatory decisions were made during the meeting.

The enclosure provides the attendance list for this meeting.

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A. D'Agostino, NRR
A. Moreno, OCA
C. Cheung, NRR
C. Leatherbury, OCHCO
C. Hunter, RES
D. Silverstein, NRR
D. Rahn, NRR
D. Halverson, RES
D. Taneja, NRR
E. Anderson, OGC
F. O'Brien, NRR
G. Blas, NRR
J. Zhao, NRR
J. Monachan, NRR
J. English, NRR
J. Paige, NRR
K. Tetter, NRR
K. Miller, NRR
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ADAMS Accession No.: ML26050A185 **NRR-106**

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NAME	JMonachan	CCheung	JPaige
DATE	02/19/2026	02/23/2026	03/02/2026

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List of Attendees

U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission Public Information Meeting

Discussion on NEI's Digital Instrumentation and Controls (DI&C) Recommendations: Accelerating NRC Reform
January 14, 2026

Name	Affiliation
Amy D'Agostino	Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC)
Angel Moreno	NRC
Calvin Cheung	NRC
Christian Leatherbury	NRC
Christopher Hunter	NRC
Daniel Silverstein	NRC
David Rahn	NRC
Derek Halverson	NRC
Dinesh Taneja	NRC
Evan Anderson	NRC
Fredrick O'Brien	NRC
Gilberto Blas	NRC
Jack Zhao	NRC
Jaison Monachan	NRC
Jason English	NRC
Jason Paige	NRC
Keith Tetter	NRC
Kenn Miller	NRC
Landen Kwan	NRC
Marshall Kohen	NRC
Mihaela Biro	NRC
Ming Li	NRC
Norbert Carte	NRC
Samir Darbali	NRC
Sergiu Basturescu	NRC
Sheldon Clark	NRC
Steven Alferink	NRC
Sunil Weerakkody	NRC
Sushil Birla	NRC
Teko Foli	NRC
William Roggenbrodt	NRC
Youssef Rokes	NRC
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Enclosure

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Rickey, Ashley	Constellation Nuclear
Samselski, Mark	Constellation Nuclear
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Eileen London	Deepfission.com
John McClure	Deepfission.com
Rani Franovich	Deepfission.com
Rebecca Bost	Deepfission.com
Ty Casey Mullen	Deepfission.com
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John M Phillips	Dominion
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GEARY Tom	Framatome
GREEN Aaron	Framatome
MCMAHON Brian	Framatome
Rich Stattel	GE Vernova
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Congjian Wang	Inl.gov
Kristen L. Willis	Inl.gov
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Tom Case	NuScale
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Ted Quinn	ParagonES.com
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Porco, Pietro G	Westinghouse
Takei, Garrett	Westinghouse
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Andrew Rankin	X-ENERGY
Hannan	X-ENERGY
Shawn Hanvy	X-ENERGY
Ahmad AlJuhan	
Alex Benim	
Amir Afzali	
Anthony Rivera	
Austin Johansen	
Baofu Lu	
Christopher Thornton	
Deann Raleigh	
James Hopf	
Justin Wearne	
Louis	
M Murphy	
Madison Schroder	
Marshall Buroff	
Megan W.	
Michael Keegan	
Paul Heaney	
Royce Lindengren	
Shawn Hanvy	
Wesley Steh	